

Jack Kelly

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GitHub: <https://github.com/jackckelly>

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Research interests Social simulation, game NPCs, game studies, authoring tools, language models

Education

University of California, Santa Cruz Santa Cruz, CA
Ph.D. in Computational Media September 2024 – June 2029
Advised by Elin Carstensdottir
M.S. in Computational Media September 2022 – August 2024
Advised by Michael Mateas and Noah Wardrip-Fruin

Brown University Providence, RI
B.S. in Computer Science September 2014 – May 2018

Awards and honors

Best Paper, AIIDE 2023
Best Paper, FDG 2023

Conference papers

Playing the Model: Ideology, Bias, and the Rhetoric of LLM Games
Jack Kelly, Noah Wardrip-Fruin, Elin Carstensdottir.
FDG 2026. 38% acceptance.
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3815598.3815659>

There and Back Again: Extracting Formal Domains for Controllable Neurosymbolic Story Authoring
Jack Kelly, Alex Calderwood, Noah Wardrip-Fruin, Michael Mateas.
AIIDE 2023. 28% acceptance. **Best Paper.**
<https://doi.org/10.1609/aiide.v19i1.27502>

Shoelace: A Storytelling Assistant for GUMSHOE One-2-One
Devi Acharya, Jack Kelly, William Tate, Maxwell Joslyn, Michael Mateas, Noah Wardrip-Fruin.
FDG 2023. 39% acceptance. **Best Paper.**
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3582437.3582475>

Workshop papers

Paradise: An Experiment Extending the Ensemble Social Physics Engine with Language Models
Jack Kelly, Michael Mateas, Noah Wardrip-Fruin.
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3649921.3659841>
FDG 2024. Workshop on Game Research Software System Reuse

Towards Computational Support with Language Models for TTRPG Game Masters

Jack Kelly, Michael Mateas, Noah Wardrip-Fruin.

FDG 2023. *Workshop on Human-AI Interaction Through Play*.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3582437.3587202>

Service and teaching

Teaching Assistantships

CMPM 148, <i>Interactive Storytelling</i>	Winter 2026
CMPM 170, <i>Rapid Prototyping</i>	Fall 2025
CMPM 176, <i>Game Systems</i>	Spring 2025
CMPM 80K, <i>Foundations of Interactive Game Design</i>	Summer 2024
CMPM 80K, <i>Foundations of Interactive Game Design</i>	Winter 2024
CSCI 1570, <i>Design and Analysis of Algorithms</i>	Fall 2017
CSCI 1951A, <i>Data Science</i>	Spring 2017

Peer Review

AIIDE	2023-2026
ICIDS	2024-2026
FDG	2026
CHI	2026
CHI Play	2025
Wordplay	2024

Industry experience

Transform (acquired by dbt Labs)

Seattle, WA

Data Engineer January 2022 – December 2022

- Worked across data infrastructure to integrate Transform’s centralized metrics store (now the dbt Semantic Layer) with upstream data sources (Snowflake, BigQuery, Redshift) and downstream consumers (Slack, Google Sheets, Excel).

Yelp

San Francisco, CA

Machine Learning Engineer August 2018 – December 2020

- On the Contribution Targeting team, developed and launched a new visit attribution model with PySpark and XGBoost using website and app interaction data; increased business reviews by 2% sitewide upon integration with the review suggestion system.
- On the Data Quality team, rebuilt Yelp’s chain business identification system to use human-in-the-loop feedback, resolving persistent data quality issues.

Programming languages

Proficient: Python, Javascript, Typescript.

Familiar : C#, Java, R.